MANUEL MUNOZ

Social Science Division ◇ New York University Abu Dhabi (NYUAD) ◇
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CURRENT AFFILIATIONS

Assistant Professor (visiting) in Business, Organizations and Society — *2025 -*
New York University Abu Dhabi

Assistant Professor (Global faculty) in Business and Economics — *2025 -*
Universidad Autonoma de Bucaramanga

Scientific Director — *2021 -*
Social Behavior and Experimental Economics Laboratory

Research Fellow — *2025 -*
Luxembourg Institute of Socio-Economic Research (LISER)

EDUCATION

Ph.D., Sociology — *2010 – 2015*
University of Groningen (Netherlands)

MSc., Economics, **with distinction* — *2008 – 2010*
University of Valencia (Spain)

BSc., Economics — *2001 – 2006*
Industrial University of Santander (Colombia)

PREVIOUS POSITIONS

Behavioral Scientist / Research Associate — *2023 - 2025*
Luxembourg Institute of Socio-economic Research (LISER)

Adjunct Lecturer — *2022 – 2023*
Social Science Division
New York University Abu Dhabi

Behavioral Scientist — *2020 – 2022*
Center for Behavioral Institutional Design (CBID)
New York University Abu Dhabi

Postdoctoral Associate — *2017 – 2020*
Social Science Division
New York University Abu Dhabi

Postdoctoral Fellow (Juan de la Cierva) — *2016 – 2017*
Economics Department
University of Valencia

RESEARCH INTERESTS

My research focuses on organizational behavior and the behavioral economics of the workplace, with a particular emphasis on how nudges and social signals drive human capital development. I examine the behavioral and structural barriers to opportunity, investigating how selection biases influence talent management and decision-making in diverse organizational environments.

WORKING PAPERS

Closing Class Gaps with Simple Nudges: Experimental Evidence on Opportunity Allocation
Revise & Resubmit - Management Science (single authored)

The Recency Bias in the Attribution of Responsibility for Joint Work
Reject & Resubmit - Economic Journal (with A. Baranski)

When Peer Endorsements Hurt: Source Attribution in Talent Recognition
Submitted (single authored)

SELECTED WORK IN PROGRESS

Gender Bias in Job Referrals (with F. Moisan, E. Reuben)
Manuscript in preparation

Peer referrals Boost Take-Up of Valuable Opportunities (with M. Acampora)
In preparation for Submission

Image Concerns in the Take-up of Targeted Opportunities (single authored)
Manuscript in preparation

PUBLISHED PAPERS

Publicly Targeting Group Identities Impacts Take-Up of Educational Opportunities — *2026*
Forthcoming - Economic Journal (single authored)

Identity Change and Economic Mobility: Experimental Evidence — *2024*
Games and Economic Behavior (single authored)

The Role of Personal and Impersonal Relational Contracts on Partner Selection and Efficiency — *2023*
Journal of Law, Economics & Organization (with E. Reuben)

Experimental Evidence Shows that Negative Motive Attribution Drives Counter-punishment — *2023*
Journal of the Economic Science Association (with N. Nikiforakis)

The Limits of Transparency in Reducing Corruption — *2021*
Journal of Behavioral and Experimental Economics (with D. Parra, L.A. Palacio)

Web of lies: A Tool for Determining the Limits of Verification in Preventing the Spread of False Information on Networks — *2021*
Scientific Reports (with K. Makovi)

Integration and Diversity — *2020*
Experimental Economics (with S. Goyal, P. Hernández, G. Martínez, F. Moisan, A. Sánchez)

Collaborative Production Networks among Unequal Actors 2020
Network Science (with J. Dijkstra, R. Wittek, A. Flache)

Equilibrium Characterization of Networks under Conflicting Preferences *2017*
Economic Letters (with P. Hernández, G. Martínez, A. Sánchez)

The Bargaining Power of Commitment: An Experiment on the Effects of Threats in the Hawk-Dove Game *2015*
Rationality & Society (with L. A. Palacio, A. Cortés)

Heterogeneous Network Games: Conflicting Preferences *2013*
Games and Economic Behavior (with P. Hernández, A. Sánchez)

GRANTS AND FUNDING

Seed Grant - NYUAD *2026*
(co-PI together with M. Molina and B. Rosche)
25,000 USD

Diversity, Inequality & Experiments Grant - NYUAD *2025*
(PI - single authored)
7,044 USD

Innovation Projects Grant - LISER *2024*
(co-PI together with B. Verheyden)
64,000 Euros

Fonds National de la Recherche Luxembourg (CORE) *2024*
(co-Investigator. PI: M. Morelli)
682,931 Euros

Experimental and Participatory Research (ExPar) - Seed Grant *2024*
(PI - single authored)
6,000 Euros

Research Grants - Universidad Católica de Colombia *2017*
(co-PI together with D. Parra and L. Palacio)
12,88 USD

Ayudas Juan de la Cierva - Spanish Ministry of Economics and Competitiveness *2017*
60,000 Euros

Traveling grant - Max Plank Institute for Human Development *2011*
1,500 Euros

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Management and Organizations (NYU Abu Dhabi) *2025 -*
*Average evaluation: 4.89/5.0

Foundations of Leadership (NYU Abu Dhabi) *2025 -*
*Average evaluation: 4.73/5.0

Markets (NYU Abu Dhabi) *2025 - 2026*

*Average evaluation: 4.4/5.0

Strategic Goals - *Virtual* (U. Autónoma de Bucaramanga) *2022 - 2025*
*Average evaluation: 4.7/5.0

Strategic Goals - *Virtual* (Universidad de San Gil) *2024*
*Average evaluation: 4.7/5.0

Fairness (NYU Abu Dhabi) *2022 – 2023*
*Average evaluation: 4.9/5.0

Application of Theories (U. Groningen) *2011 – 2014*
*Average evaluation: 3.3/4.0

Social Networks (Evangelisches Studienwerk Villigst, Germany) *2015*
*Average evaluation: 1.81 in 1-5 (*inverted*: 1 is highest)

CONSULTING

Specialist consultant: Debiasing performance evaluations 2022 - 2023
KPMG Middle East

Subject matter expert in Behavioral Sciences 2022
KPMG Middle East – Dubai Executive Council

POLICY REPORTS & OTHER PUBLICATIONS

An Experimental Evaluation of the Forever Fit Program 2021
Policy Report - Department of Community Development Abu Dhabi, UAE
(with N. Nikiforakis, E. Reuben, A. Dariel, U. Afzal)

Exploring Nudges to Promote Physical Activity Among Senior Adults in Abu Dhabi 2020
Policy Report - Department of Community Development Abu Dhabi, UAE
(with N. Nikiforakis, E. Reuben, A. Dariel, U. Afzal)

Physical Activity for Senior Adults in Abu Dhabi 2020
Policy Report - Department of Community Development Abu Dhabi, UAE
(with N. Nikiforakis, E. Reuben, A. Dariel, U. Afzal)

Promoting Physical Activity Among Seniors in Abu Dhabi: An Experimental Test of the "Forever Fit" Nudge *2024*
Journal of the Economic Science Association
(with N. Nikiforakis, L. Alhyas, U. Afzal, A. Agiostratitis, E. Alfalacy, A. Dariel, M. Monney, E. Reuben)

PhD SUPERVISION

Jhon Díaz (PhD student - U. Jaume I, Castellón)

Genesis Amaya (PhD student - LISER)

Reha Tuncer (PhD student - U. Luxembourg)
*Defended December 2025

SERVICE

Referee for: Organization Science, Management Science; Labor Economics; Games and Economic Behavior; European Economic Review; Experimental Economics; J. Economic Behavior & Organizations; PlosOne; Journal of Behavioral and Experimental Economics; J. Economics Psychology; Theory & Decision; The B.E. Journal of Economic Analysis and Policy, Mathematical Social Science; Rationality & Society; Advances in Complex Systems

Conference Organization: II Social Behavior and Experiments Meeting - Social Bee Meet Colombia (2026); International Symposium on Experimental Economics - NYU Abu Dhabi (2026), Social Behavior and Experiments Meeting - Social Bee Meet Luxembourg (2026); 14th Field Days - Experiments Outside the Lab (2025); International Symposium on Experimental Economics - NYU Abu Dhabi (2018), International Symposium on Experimental Economics - NYU Abu Dhabi (2017), Workshop on the Frontiers of Network Science - NYU Abu Dhabi (2017), Dynamics & Collective Phenomena of Socio-Economic Systems - U. Valencia (2009), International Meeting on Exp. Behavioral Economics - U. Granada (2008)

Seminar Organization: Seminar series on Ethics, Economics and Experiments - LISER (2023 - 2025); PhD mentoring group on experimental research - LISER (2023 - 2025)

Committees: Member of the Ethics Review Committee - LISER (2024-2025); Member of the competence center on Experimental and Participatory Research - LISER (2023-2025)

INVITED SEMINARS

2026. U. Autonoma de Bucaramanga.

2025. U. Konstanz, ESADE, U. Valencia, U. Castellón, Kalrsruhe (KIT).

2024. U. Frankfurt, NYU Abu Dhabi, Utrecht U.

2023. LISER-Luxembourg, Loyola U. Córdoba, FAU-Nuremberg.

2022. U. Castellón, U. East Anglia, IMT Lucca.

2021. U. Paris Nanterre.

2019. U. Tilburg, LISER-Luxembourg, WZB-Berlin, Maastricht U.

2018. U. Cologne, Central Bank Colombia.

2015. UIS-Bucaramanga, UNAB-Bucaramanga.

2014. UIS-Bucaramanga, Maastricht U.

2012. U. Castellón, U. Utrecht.

2011. U. Valencia, Maastricht U.

CONFERENCES

2026. 3rd Esade Workshop in Behavioral and Experimental Economics; 1st Inequality Conference (NYU Abu Dhabi), Social Bee Meet Luxembourg (LISER)

2025. Workshop on the Frontiers of Network Science (NYU Abu Dhabi), 14th Field Days - Experiments Outside the Lab (Luxembourg).

2024. 4th Virtual Discrimination and Diversity workshop (UEA, U. Exeter, Loughborough U.), Advances with Field Experiments (LSE), 3rd Workshop on Field Experiments in Economics and Business (Tech. U. Munich), 4th Experimental Sociology

Workshop (Online), 13th Field Days - Experiments Outside the Lab (Amsterdam U), WoBE@E on Governance and Behavior (Valencia)

2023. iSee (NYU Abu Dhabi), Workshop on the Frontiers of Network Science (NYU New York), ESA World Meeting (Lyon), 2nd Workshop on Field Experiments in Economics and Business (Dusseldorf), Matterhorn Symposium on Behavior, Institutions and Cooperation (Brig), 5th Dondena Workshop on Public Policy (U. Bocconi)

2022. iSee (NYU Abu Dhabi), BiNoMa workshop on Economic Networks (U. Navarra), Inaugural Meeting of the MENA Network of Experimental Social Scientists (NYU Abu Dhabi)

2021. Bogotá Exp. Econ. Conf. (U. Rosario), 7th Annual Workshop on Behav. Game Theory (U. East Anglia, Norwich), 6th Behav. Econ. Policy Symp. (Maastricht U.)

2020. ESA Global Conference.

2019. Winter Experimental Social Sciences Institute (Abu Dhabi), ESA Asia-Pacific Meeting (Abu Dhabi), Workshop in the Frontiers of Network Science – WTFNS (Abu Dhabi), IMEBESS (Utrecht U.)

2018. Bogotá Exp. Econ. Conf. (U. Rosario), iSee (NYU Abu Dhabi), Workshop on the Frontiers of Network Science (NYU Abu Dhabi), 4th Conf. on Network Science in Econ. (Vanderbilt U.), IMEBESS (E.U.I. Florence), ESA World Meeting (Berlin), 4th Annual Workshop on Behav. Game Theory (U. East Anglia, Norwich), 1st Workshop on Exp. Econ (UNAB)

2017. IMEBESS (U. A. Barcelona), 1st Workshop on Industrial Econ. (U. Valencia), 2nd Annual Research Poster Day (NYU Abu Dhabi)

2016. 26th Game Theory Festival (SUNY at Stony Brook, New York)

2013. Annual Conf. of the American Sociol. Assoc. (New York), Pre-conference Rat. Choice Sec. (Am. Sociol. Assoc., New York)

2012. U4 Workshop (University of Ghent), 23rd Game Theory Festival (SUNY at Stony Brook, New York)

2011. 10th Workshop on Networks in Econ. and Sociol. (U. Utrecht), 3rd UECE Lisbon Meetings - Game Theory and Applications (U. Lisbon)

2010. 2nd UECE Lisbon Meetings - Game Theory and Applications (U. Lisbon)

2009. 6th Int. Meeting on Exp. & Behavioral Econ. (U. Basque Country), Dynamics & Collective Phenomena of Socio-Economic Systems (U. Valencia)

RESEARCH VISITS

2022. Visiting Scholar, ESADE Business School (July - Aug)

2018. Visiting Scholar, University of Cologne (June – July)

2014. Visiting Scholar, Columbia Business School (April – May)

2013. Visiting Scholar, Columbia Business School (August - November)

MISCELLANEOUS

Programming/Software: zTree, oTree, LaTex, Python, HTML5, CSS

Languages: Spanish (native), English (proficient)

Citizenship: Colombian

REFERENCES

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